Academia Blockchain

Crypto World's Fair - Final Submission

Academia Blockchain

Academia Blockchain is a collaborative learning and knowledge-preservation platform. Communities build shared libraries, collections and knowledge paths. Users can preserve content, generate transcripts for the entire community, interact with documents and transcripts through AI, and anchor hashes to Bitcoin for verifiable provenance. We also issue non-transferable educational credentials on Ethereum linked to knowledge path snapshots preserved on IPFS.

Alejandro Veintimilla

Submission status

Submit by

Submission deadline: October 12, 2026 at 11:59 PM PDT

Project details

Project website

https://www.academiablockchain.com/

What are you building, and who is it for?

Academia Blockchain is a collaborative infrastructure for learning, curating, and preserving knowledge. Users and communities create shared libraries, collections, and structured knowledge paths from documents, videos, articles, and other sources. The community can preserve files, generate transcripts that become available to everyone, and use AI to interact with documents and transcripts.
We add a verification layer to knowledge: content and transcripts can be hashed and anchored to Bitcoin for provenance, while completed knowledge paths can issue non-transferable educational credentials on Ethereum, linked to snapshots of those knowledge paths preserved on IPFS.
We are building for independent learners, educators, researchers, and communities that want to collectively organize and preserve knowledge, explore it with AI, collaboratively create timelines and other visualizations, download and pin source materials, and verify their provenance.

Why did you decide to build this, and why build it now?

Generative AI has extraordinary potential, but it also makes convincing synthetic content and competing versions of events easier to create. We believe communities need tools to collaboratively gather, organize, share and preserve knowledge for the long term. Academia Blockchain enables community-maintained libraries, transcripts and knowledge paths, with AI tools to explore them. Content and transcripts can be hashed and anchored to Bitcoin, creating durable evidence of what existed at a given point in time. Knowledge path snapshots are preserved on IPFS and linked to non-transferable educational credentials on Ethereum. We are building this now so that, 30 or 100 years from today, people can look back, verify what was documented, and distinguish preserved history from what may have been altered or lost—while making learning more connected and efficient in an increasingly fragmented and chaotic world.

What technologies are you using or integrating with to build your product?

Django, React, OpenAI, Bitcoin, Ethereum, Docker, Qdrant, Postgres

Which chains does your product use?

Ethereum L1
Bitcoin

How does your product use these chains?

Bitcoin anchors hashes of content and community-generated transcripts, creating timestamped proofs of provenance and integrity. Ethereum issues non-transferable educational credentials when users complete knowledge paths. Each credential links to an IPFS snapshot of the completed path, preserving what was studied and allowing the credential and its underlying learning record to remain independently verifiable.

Is your project a mobile-focused dApp?

No

Where is your team primarily based?

Ecuador

Please share a team Telegram contact

stormearthfire

Did anyone not listed on the team here do meaningful work on this project? If so, please explain.

I have been the project's primary developer throughout its development. Other contributors have made minor contributions, documented in the repository's commit history.

Is there anything else judges should know about your project that isn't captured above?

An active community from my social networks is already testing the platform. Sophia's educational platform predates the hackathon; our planned hackathon work focuses on Ethereum certificates, immutable course snapshots on IPFS, their verification experience and Bitcoin transcript anchoring (this is a separate feature that works independently of course certification)

University project

No

Media and code

Check that judges can open these links and follow any access instructions.

GitHub link

https://github.com/Alejoss/Sophia.AI

Please share any important context about your repo

This repository predates the hackathon. I have developed the platform over several years to provide education for a community active for over a decade, with occasional commits from community members. The existing code included the educational platform and a draft of Bitcoin transcript anchoring. Our planned hackathon work adds Ethereum NFT certificates, immutable course snapshots, perfected Bitcoin anchoring and public verification.

Please submit a demo video of your product

https://youtu.be/4GDTp398C8M

Show demo video on the public project page

No

Live product link

https://www.academiablockchain.com/

Access instructions

I can't give you access to the dashboard since its on production. You could test the functionalities from the perspective of a student or a knowledge path creator. The register and login process is pretty straight forward. I've translated the site to english for this hackaton.

Pitch video

https://youtu.be/gm_Qb5UCYMQ

X profile

aca_blockchain
Alejandro Veintimilla (you)

Submission profile: Complete

Your submission profile answers

Accelerator application

How do you know people actually need, or will need this product?

Universities as we know them may change profoundly. They were built for a time when knowledge lived mainly in books and professors needed to share physical space with students. Today, information is abundant. A new educational paradigm is emerging, one in which the center of learning can shift from the institution toward teachers - or “guides,” as we call them.
The most effective guides will create knowledge paths that help learners navigate the learning process. Academia Blockchain is designed to be the platform where that guidance, research, and interaction can live.

Platforms that want to contribute to the future of education will also need to help people investigate information, find relevant source material, and preserve verifiable educational credentials over time. Academia Blockchain is built for a world where information is fragmented, echo chambers coexist with AI-generated content, and students can lose valuable time in endless scrolling.

How far along are you? Do you have users? Please be as specific as possible.

Academia Blockchain has an active community that follows our technology education content across several social networks, primarily YouTube. The platform is live and functional. A small group of community members is beginning to test a few knowledge paths, and we are close to launching an official course on the history of Bitcoin.
Across our social channels, we have around 20,000 followers and the website receives approximately 250 unique visitors per day.

Who else is building in this space, and what do you think they're getting wrong?

Academia.edu and Scribd provide broad libraries of content, but they focus primarily on access and discovery rather than helping communities organize material into learner-directed knowledge paths. Khan Academy and Coursera provide structured courses, but their experiences are generally institution- or provider-led and do not combine an open, collaborative library with research tools and transcript-based AI exploration.
Academia Blockchain takes a different approach: people can organize and follow knowledge paths, investigate source material, work with transcripts and AI, and preserve verifiable evidence. Bitcoin transcript anchoring and Ethereum-linked educational credentials make that evidence part of the learning experience, rather than a separate afterthought.

How do you make money, or how do you plan to?

Today, we sell access to curated knowledge paths and platform credits. Learners use credits to interact with content transcripts through AI-assisted research tools and to request Bitcoin transcript anchoring. We also accept cryptocurrency payments for eligible platform purchases.

How long have you each been working on this? Have you been working on it full time?

I have been working on Academia Blockchain since 2017. For most of that time, it was a part-time project to which I dedicated one or two hours a day, while building a YouTube community around it. It became my main project in 2025, and I have been working on it full time since January 2026.

Where is each member of the team currently based, and do you work in-person together?

I am currently based in Quito, Ecuador, and work from home. I am the only person working on Academia Blockchain full time.
Over the years, community managers, video editors, volunteer developers, and teachers have made occasional contributions to the project.